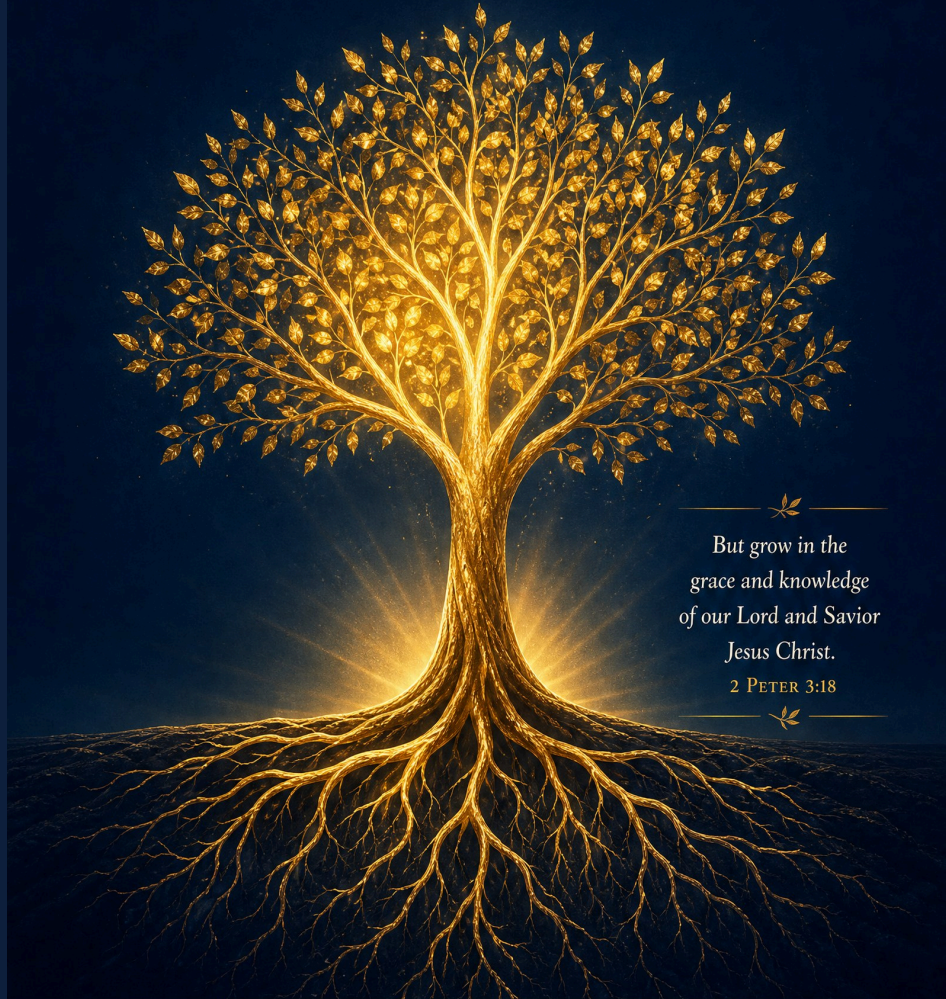


GROW

THE DISCIPLESHIP JOURNEY • BOOK 2



But grow in the
grace and knowledge
of our Lord and Savior
Jesus Christ.

2 PETER 3:18

From Welcome to Witness
Thomas Perdana

THE DISCIPLESHIP JOURNEY • BOOK 2 OF 3

Intermediate Track

By Thomas Perdana

GROW: Building Habits and Discovering Your S.H.A.P.E.

Part of The Discipleship Journey: From Welcome to Witness

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Building Habits & Discovering Your S.H.A.P.E.

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CHAPTER 1: BEYOND THE BASICS: MOVING FROM MILK TO SOLID MEAT

“As ye have therefore received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk ye in him: Rooted and built up in him, and stablished in the faith, as ye have been taught, abounding therein with thanksgiving.” — Colossians 2:6-7 (KJV)

Toddler Shoes in an Adult World

Imagine walking into a corporate boardroom and seeing a 35-year-old executive sitting in an expensive suit, wearing light-up toddler shoes, sucking on a baby bottle, and speaking in babble. You would be shocked and deeply concerned!

Yet, in thousands of churches every Sunday morning, a spiritual tragedy of the exact same proportion takes place.

Millions of believers have been saved for five, ten, or twenty years, yet they remain spiritual infants! They sit in church pews week after week, totally dependent on a pastor to spoon-feed them spiritual milk. The moment a trial hits, a temptation arises, or a doctrinal wind blows, they are tossed to and fro like helpless children (Ephesians 4:14). They have never learned to feed themselves from the Word of God, never developed daily prayer habits, and have no idea what supernatural **Spiritual Gifts** God placed inside them!

In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, God does not call you to live your entire life in spiritual diapers. **God calls you to grow up!**

“For when for the time ye ought to be teachers, ye have need that one teach you again which be the first principles of the oracles of God; and are become such as have need of milk, and not of strong meat. For every one that useth milk is unskilful in the word of righteousness: for he is a baby. But strong meat belongeth to them that are of full age...” — Hebrews 5:12-14 (KJV)

Rooted and Built Up: A KJV Word Study

In Colossians 2:6-7, the Apostle Paul uses two vivid illustrations from agriculture and architecture to define true spiritual growth:

1. **“Rooted” (*Errhizomenoi*):** Like a massive oak tree whose roots dig ten feet down into deep soil, anchoring the tree so that no hurricane can uproot it. Your roots must sink deep into the living water of KJV Scripture!
2. **“Built Up” (*Epoikodomoumenoi*):** Like a majestic stone cathedral being constructed block by block upon a granite foundation. Spiritual growth is not an accidental event; it is an intentional, systematic construction project!

As a jail chaplain ministering in Seminole County and Orange County Jail, I have watched God perform this exact transformation in incarcerated men. When a prisoner surrenders to Christ, he starts on spiritual milk. But as he digs into his KJV Bible, builds daily quiet-time habits, and completes discipleship training, his spiritual roots sink deep. Within months, that former inmate is standing strong inside his pod as a spiritual leader—teaching God’s Word, praying over sick inmates, and operating in his spiritual gifts!

If God can raise up unshakeable Kingdom leaders inside a correctional facility, He will do the exact same in your life as you step into Book 2!

The Two Core Pillars of Book 2 (GROW)

To take you beyond the basics into vibrant spiritual maturity, *GROW* is built upon two master pillars:

“Let’s Get Real”: Assessing Your Current Growth Level

Where are you currently standing on your spiritual journey? Examine the three stages of spiritual development below:

1. **Spiritual Infant (Milk Stage):** Relies entirely on others for spiritual nourishment; easily discouraged by trials; lacks consistent daily habits.
2. **Growing Believer (Meat Stage - *Your Goal in Book 2!*):** Feeds self daily from Scripture; maintains regular prayer life; understands personal Spiritual Gifts; actively serves in a local church.
3. **Spiritual Leader/Father (Multiplying Stage):** Disciples younger believers; leads small groups or ministry teams; reproduces spiritual life in others.

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **Moving Past Milk:** Read Hebrews 5:12-14. What areas of your spiritual life are still relying on “milk” instead of “strong meat”?
2. **Rooted & Built Up:** Look at Colossians 2:6-7. How do daily spiritual habits act like deep roots during stormy seasons of life?
3. **Unlocking Your S.H.A.P.E.:** Why is discovering your supernatural Spiritual Gifts essential for finding your exact fit in the Body of Christ?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

- ✦ **Practical Action Step:** Perform an honest **Growth Audit**. Set aside 15 minutes today to evaluate your daily habits (Bible reading, prayer, giving, community). Write down one specific growth goal you will achieve through this book.
- ✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

“Lord God Almighty, I refuse to remain a spiritual infant! I step out of complacency today and declare that I am ready to grow into strong spiritual maturity. Sink my roots deep into Your Word, build my life upon the rock of Christ, and reveal my supernatural Spiritual Gifts as I study this book. Clothe me in my royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king to serve Your house. In Jesus’ victorious Name, Amen.”

CHAPTER 2: THE HABIT OF THE WORD: FEEDS YOUR SOUL DAILY

“This book of the law shall not depart out of thy mouth; but thou shalt meditate therein day and night, that thou mayest observe to do according to all that is written therein: for then thou shalt make thy way prosperous, and then thou shalt have good success.” — Joshua 1:8 (KJV)

Starving at a 7-Course Banquet

Imagine a man sitting at a lavish banquet table overflowing with fresh roast beef, warm bread, crisp vegetables, and sweet fruit. Yet, despite being surrounded by food, he lays his head on the table and slowly starves to death!

Tragically, millions of modern Christians live in spiritual starvation while sitting in the middle of a 7-course spiritual feast!

We live in an age where the Bible is available on every smartphone, tablet, computer, and bookshelf. Yet, recent studies reveal that less than 15% of churchgoers read the Bible daily. We spend three to four hours a day scrolling through social media, watching secular news, and consuming entertainment, but we complain that we “*don’t have 15 minutes*” to feed our immortal souls!

Jesus confronted this deception when He declared: “*Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God*” (Matthew 4:4).

If you feed your physical body three meals a day but feed your spiritual soul only one meal on Sunday morning, **your spirit is malnourished!** In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, the first non-negotiable habit of spiritual maturity is building a **Daily Habit of the Word**.

Chewing the Cud: A KJV Word Study on Joshua 1:8

In Joshua 1:8, as Joshua prepared to lead Israel into the Promised Land, God gave him the exact secret to spiritual strength and success: “*thou shalt meditate therein day and night.*”

The Hebrew word for *meditate* is **hagah**. It does not mean emptying your mind (like Eastern meditation). **Hagah** means to ponder, mutter, speak aloud, and ruminate continuously—exactly like a cow chewing the cud!

A cow swallows grass, brings it back up to chew on it again, and extracts every drop of nutrient and richness from it. When you meditate on KJV Scripture, you don't just skim through words to check a religious box; you chew on a verse all day long at your desk, in your car, and on your walk until its divine truth saturates your heart and mind!

As Vice President of Gideons International in North Seminole County, Florida, and as a volunteer chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jails, I have witnessed the supernatural power of Scripture. Inside a prison cell, when an inmate receives a free KJV Testament and begins to *meditate* on its pages, his language changes, his anger melts, and his criminal mindset is destroyed by the washing of water by the Word (Ephesians 5:26)!

The 5 Fingers of Grasping God's Word

To hold fast to the Bible so that Satan cannot rip it out of your hand, you must master the **5 Fingers of Grasping God's Word**:

Try holding a Bible using only your pinky finger. If someone taps it, the Bible drops! But when you wrap all **5 fingers** around the Word—Hearing, Reading, Studying, Memorizing, and Meditating—your grip becomes unshakeable!

1. **HEAR (Pinky)**: Listen faithfully to KJV preaching and audio Scripture (Romans 10:17).
2. **READ (Ring)**: Read 15 minutes daily to see the big picture of God's story (Revelation 1:3).
3. **STUDY (Middle)**: Dig into cross-references, word meanings, and historical context (Acts 17:11).
4. **MEMORIZE (Index)**: Store key verses in your heart as spiritual ammunition (Psalm 119:11).
5. **MEDITATE (Thumb - The Stabilizer)**: Ruminates on truth day and night (Joshua 1:8).

The Interactive S.O.A.P. Journaling Method

To transform your daily Bible reading from a routine chore into a living encounter with God, use the proven **S.O.A.P. Method**:

“Let's Get Real”: How to Build a 15-Minute Daily Word Habit

If you struggle with consistency, start with the **15-Minute Rule**:

- ✦ **Pick a Specific Time**: Early morning before checking your phone is best (Mark 1:35).
- ✦ **Pick a Specific Place**: A quiet chair, desk, or kitchen table free from noise.
- ✦ **Set a Timer**: 2 minutes to pray, 8 minutes to read, 5 minutes to S.O.A.P. journal.

Do this for 21 consecutive days, and it will become an automatic, life-giving habit!

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **Chewing the Cud**: Look at Joshua 1:8. How can you practice *meditating* (*hagah*) on a single Bible verse throughout your workday tomorrow?

2. **The 5 Fingers:** Which of the 5 fingers (Hearing, Reading, Studying, Memorizing, Meditating) is currently your weakest, and how will you strengthen it this week?
3. **S.O.A.P. Journaling:** How does writing down your *Application* step prevent you from being a hearer of the Word only (James 1:22)?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

- ✦ **Practical Action Step:** Purchase a small journal or open a digital note. Tomorrow morning, open your KJV Bible, read one chapter (start in the Gospel of John or Romans), and complete your first **S.O.A.P. Journal Entry** using the template above!
- ✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

“Father in Heaven, Your Word is a lamp unto my feet and a light unto my path! Forgive me for the times I have starved my soul while surrounded by Your truth. Give me a holy hunger for KJV Scripture. Teach me to hear, read, study, memorize, and meditate on Your Word daily. Make my life fruitful and prosperous as I obey Your truth. In Jesus’ glorious Name, Amen.”

CHAPTER 3: THE HABIT OF PRAYER: TALKING & LISTENING TO GOD

“But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret; and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly.” — Matthew 6:6 (KJV)

The Direct Line to the King’s Oval Office

Imagine receiving a gold-embossed card that grants you direct, 24/7 access to the Oval Office of the President or the palace of the King. You don’t need an appointment, you don’t need a secretary’s clearance, and you can walk in at any hour of the day or night to speak face-to-face with the ruler of the nation.

You would consider that card the most valuable treasure in your wallet!

Yet, every single born-again child of God possesses a direct line to an immeasurably higher throne—the **Throne of the King of Kings and Lord of Lords!** Through the precious blood of Jesus, the veil was rent in twain, granting you bold, instant access into the Holy of Holies (Hebrews 4:16).

Why, then, do so many growing believers treat prayer like a boring religious obligation?

We rush through a 10-second “bless this food” prayer before dinner, murmur a panicked “help me, Lord” prayer when our car breaks down, and wonder why our spiritual life feels dry and powerless.

In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, prayer is not a religious monologue recited to convince a reluctant God. **Prayer is an intimate, two-way conversation with a loving Heavenly Father who delights to hear your voice!**

The Secret Prayer Closet: A KJV Exegesis of Matthew 6:6

In Matthew 6:6, King Jesus commands His disciples: *“enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret.”*

The Greek word used for *closet* is **tameion**, which referred to an inner private chamber, a secret storage vault, or a royal treasury in an ancient house.

Notice three profound spiritual laws in this verse:

1. **The Secret Place:** God demands a place free from human eyes, performance, and religious showmanship (Matthew 6:5). In the secret closet, you drop your public mask and get totally real with God.
2. **Shutting the Door:** Shutting the door is an intentional act of warfare! You shut out noise, notifications, cell phone alerts, family distractions, and racing thoughts so your mind is focused solely on the King.
3. **Open Reward:** What is whispered in the secret closet is rewarded openly in your character, spiritual power, and answered prayers!

As a volunteer jail chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jail, I have witnessed the holy power of the secret prayer closet behind steel bars. In a loud, chaotic jail pod with 60 inmates yelling and televisions blaring, an inmate will pull a towel over his head in his bunk to create his secret *tameion*. With tears falling onto his concrete floor, he shuts the door to the world and pours out his heart to God. I have seen those hidden tears bring miraculous legal grace, restore broken marriages, and fill men with a deep, supernatural peace that passes all human understanding (Philippians 4:7)!

The 4-Part A.C.T.S. Conversational Prayer Model

If you have ever knelt to pray and found your mind wandering to your grocery list or work emails after 60 seconds, you need a spiritual roadmap! The **A.C.T.S. Model** is a time-tested, biblical framework that structures your 15-minute daily prayer time into four vibrant movements:

1. ADORATION (Praising God's Attributes)

Start by turning your eyes away from your problems and onto the majesty of God! Praise Him for His divine nature—His omnipotence, His holiness, His unshakeable faithfulness, and His infinite mercy (Psalm 103:1-5).

2. CONFESSION (Clearing the Air)

Unconfessed sin clogs your spiritual lungs and hinders prayer (Psalm 66:18). Agree with God about where you failed in thought, word, or deed. The moment you confess, 1 John 1:9 promises instant, complete cleansing!

3. THANKSGIVING (Counting Your Blessings)

Gratitude destroys bitterness and anxiety. Name specific blessings out loud—your salvation, physical health, daily bread, church family, and past answered prayers (1 Thessalonians 5:18).

4. SUPPLICATION & INTERCESSION (Asking & Standing in the Gap)

Bring your personal requests to God with bold confidence (Hebrews 4:16). But don't just pray for yourself—be a royal priest standing in the gap for your family, pastors, government leaders, coworkers, and lost souls!

Hearing God's Voice: Two-Way Prayer

Prayer is not just you talking to God; **prayer is also listening to God!**

After completing your A.C.T.S. prayer, do not rush off immediately. Spend 2 minutes sitting in quiet silence with your notebook open. In 1 Kings 19:12, God spoke to Elijah not through the strong wind, earthquake, or fire, but in a “*still small voice*.”

As you wait quietly before the Lord:

- ✦ The Holy Spirit will bring a specific Bible verse to your mind.
- ✦ He may prompt you to text an encouraging word to a hurting friend.
- ✦ He may reveal a sin you need to make right or a step of obedience to take.

Write down those gentle spiritual promptings in your prayer journal!

“Let’s Get Real”: How to Overcome Prayer Dryness & Distraction

When your mind wanders during prayer, don’t give up! Use the **Praying Scripture Back to God** technique. Open your KJV Bible to a Psalm (e.g., Psalm 23 or Psalm 91) and turn each verse into a personalized prayer:

- ✦ *Verse: “The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.”*
- ✦ *Your Prayer: “Lord Jesus, thank You for being my personal Shepherd today. Because You lead me, I refuse to fear financial lack or worry about tomorrow!”*

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **The Secret Closet:** Read Matthew 6:6. Where is your physical or spiritual “closet” (*tameion*) where you can shut the door and pray to your Father in secret?
2. **The A.C.T.S. Model:** Which of the four parts of A.C.T.S. (Adoration, Confession, Thanksgiving, Supplication) is most often missing from your prayer life?
3. **Listening in Silence:** Why is setting aside 2 minutes of quiet silence after prayer essential for hearing the *still small voice* of the Holy Spirit?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

- ✦ **Practical Action Step:** Designate your **Prayer Closet** today (a quiet corner in your bedroom, office, or porch). Set a 15-minute timer tomorrow morning, open your notebook, and pray through the **A.C.T.S. Model**, ending with 2 minutes of quiet listening.
- ✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

“Heavenly Father, Lord of Heaven and Earth, thank You for tearing the veil and opening the door to Your Throne of Grace! Forgive me for neglecting the sacred privilege of prayer. Teach me to enter my secret closet

daily, shut the door to worldly distractions, and pour out my heart in Adoration, Confession, Thanksgiving, and Supplication. Tune my ears to hear Your still small voice. In Jesus' mighty, victorious Name, Amen."

CHAPTER 4: THE HABIT OF GIVING: MANAGING THE KING'S TREASURY

“Give, and it shall be given unto you; good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over, shall men give into your bosom. For with the same measure that ye mete withal it shall be measured to you again.” — Luke 6:38 (KJV)

The Sea of Galilee vs. The Dead Sea Principle

In the Holy Land of Israel, two famous bodies of water are fed by the exact same river—the Jordan River:

1. **The Sea of Galilee:** Located in the north, it receives fresh water from the Jordan River and continuously pours water out southward into the river valley. Because it has both an **inflow** and an **outflow**, the Sea of Galilee is vibrant, fresh, and teeming with fish, flora, and biological life!
2. **The Dead Sea:** Located in the south, it receives the exact same Jordan River water. But the Dead Sea has **no outflow**! It absorbs water continuously, but never releases a drop. Over centuries, minerals and salt accumulated until the salinity reached 34%. Today, the Dead Sea is completely stagnant—no fish can swim in it, no trees can grow on its shores, and its water is bitter and poisonous.

In the realm of spiritual growth, human souls operate under this exact same law!

A believer who only receives—consuming sermons, downloading worship songs, receiving pastoral care, and accumulating blessings—but **never gives back** becomes a **Dead Sea Christian**! Their spirit turns bitter, self-centered, critical, and spiritually stagnant.

In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, building the **Habit of Giving** keeps the fresh rivers of the Holy Spirit flowing through your soul like the Sea of Galilee!

Pressed Down and Running Over: A KJV Exegesis of Luke 6:38

In Luke 6:38, King Jesus reveals the supernatural law of divine return: “Give, and it shall be given unto you...”

To understand this verse, look at how grain was bought and sold in ancient Middle Eastern marketplaces:

- ✦ When a buyer bought a measure of wheat, an honest merchant did not loosely pour the grain into the measuring basket.
- ✦ First, he filled the basket to the brim.

- ✦ Second, he **pressed it down** with his hands to eliminate air pockets.
- ✦ Third, he **shook the container together** so the kernels settled into every corner.
- ✦ Fourth, he poured more grain on top until it was **running over** the edges into the buyer's folded robe (*bosom*)!

Jesus promises that when you give with an open, generous heart, God measures back to you in that exact same lavish, overflowing proportion!

“There is that scattereth, and yet increaseth; and there is that withholdeth more than is meet, but it tendeth to poverty. The liberal soul shall be made fat: and he that watereth shall be watered also himself.” — Proverbs 11:24-25 (KJV)

As Vice President of Gideons International in North Seminole County, Florida, and as a volunteer jail chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jails, I have seen how faithful giving from ordinary Christians transforms destinies. Your giving funds free KJV Testaments placed in hotels, schools, and jail cells—and I have watched indigent inmates in jail pods share their meager commissary items (socks, soap, snacks) with newly arrived prisoners who had nothing. Their generosity in the midst of poverty is a fragrant offering to King Jesus!

The 4 Master Rules for Biblical Stewardship

To manage the King's treasury with honor and order, master these **4 Master Rules of Stewardship**:

Rule 1: PLAN IT (Budget Stewardship)

Generosity does not happen by accident. If you wait to see “what's left over” at the end of the month, there will never be anything left! Put giving at the very top of your monthly budget.

Rule 2: PRIORITIZE IT (First-Fruits Honor)

Proverbs 3:9 commands: *“Honor the LORD with thy substance, and with the firstfruits of all thine increase.”* The first 10% belongs to God. You give to God *first*, acknowledging Him as your ultimate Provider, before paying rent, groceries, or utilities.

Rule 3: PERCENTAGE IT (The Tithe & Offerings)

The tithe (10% of gross income) is brought to your local church storehouse (Malachi 3:10). Freewill offerings are over-and-above gifts given to special ministry needs, prison outreach, and helping the poor.

Rule 4: PROMPTLY ACT (Holy Spirit Obeying)

When the Holy Spirit prompts your heart during a Sunday service or while reading about a needy ministry, do not hesitate or argue. Act promptly! Prompt obedience breaks the spirit of greed.

The 10-10-80 Financial Allocation Model

For growing believers seeking financial freedom and spiritual alignment, implement the **10-10-80 Model**:

When you live on 80% of your income under God's blessing, **that 80% will go infinitely further than 100% lived under a financial curse!** (Haggai 1:6, Malachi 3:10-11).

“Let's Get Real”: What If I Have Outstanding Debt?

A common question is: *“Should I tithe while paying off credit card or medical debt?”*

Yes! Tithing is not a bill you pay; it is an act of covenant trust. When you honor God first in debt seasons, God rebukes the devourer for your sake (Malachi 3:11) and grants you divine wisdom, discipline, and unexpected provision to wipe out your debt far faster than human math could ever calculate!

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **Galilee vs. Dead Sea:** Is your spiritual life currently acting more like the Sea of Galilee (flowing out) or the Dead Sea (absorbing only)?
2. **First-Fruits Honor:** Read Proverbs 3:9-10. What does giving God the *firstfruits* of your income demonstrate about your heart's trust in Him?
3. **The 10-10-80 Model:** How can implementing a structured written budget help you become a joyful, hilarious giver (2 Corinthians 9:7)?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

✦ **Practical Action Step:** Sit down today with your income statement and create a **Kingdom Budget**. Set up automated recurring giving for your 10% tithe to your local church so that your first-fruits giving is executed systematically every payday!

✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

“Lord God of Hosts, Provider of my soul, I acknowledge that 100% of my wealth, health, and talent comes from Your hand! Forgive me for holding tightly to worldly money out of fear or greed. Today I break the spirit of scarcity over my life. Make my soul like the Sea of Galilee—a fresh, vibrant channel of Your blessings. I dedicate my tithes and offerings to build Your house, reach the lost, and advance Your Kingdom. In Jesus' glorious Name, Amen.”

CHAPTER 5: THE HABIT OF COMMUNITY: FELLOWSHIP & SMALL GROUPS

“And they, continuing daily with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread from house to house, did eat their meat with gladness and singleness of heart, Praising God, and having favour with all the people.”
— Acts 2:46-47 (KJV)

The Lone Ember on the Cold Hearth

Imagine sitting by a roaring campfire on a crisp autumn night. The logs are burning with intense heat and bright orange flames. Now, take a pair of tongs, reach into the center of the fire, pull out one glowing red-hot ember, and set it all by itself on a cold stone off to the side.

What happens to that isolated ember?

Within 60 seconds, the bright red glow fades. Within two minutes, smoke stops rising. Within five minutes, the ember turns ashy grey, cools down to the touch, and dies!

Now, pick that cold, grey ember back up with the tongs and toss it right back into the middle of the burning fire. What happens? Almost instantly, the heat of the surrounding coals ignites the ember, and it catches fire again!

In the spiritual realm, human souls operate under this exact law.

Millions of modern Christians attempt to live as **isolated embers**. They attend a Sunday service once or twice a month, slip in after the opening song, sit in the back row, slip out to their car before the final prayer, and have zero deep relationships with other believers. Then they wonder why they feel spiritually cold, weak against temptation, and overwhelmed by anxiety!

“Two are better than one; because they have a good reward for their labour. For if they fall, the one will lift up his fellow: but woe to him that is alone when he falleth; for he hath not another to help him up.”
— Ecclesiastes 4:9-10 (KJV)

In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, you were never created to be a solo ranger. You need the heat, protection, and accountability of **Biblical Small Group Community**!

Two-Legged Church Life: A KJV Exegesis of Acts 2:46

In Acts 2:46, the Holy Spirit gives us the exact architectural blueprint of the early Church: *“continuing daily with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread from house to house.”*

Notice that early Christian life walked on **Two Legs**:

- ✦ **Leg 1: The Temple (Large Group Corporate Celebration):** Gathering as an entire congregation on Sunday for high praise, public preaching, water baptism, and corporate vision.
- ✦ **Leg 2: House-to-House (Small Group Fellowship & Care):** Gathering in living rooms, coffee shops, or small circles to study Scripture, share meals (*“breaking bread”*), share personal burdens, and pray for one another.

If a person tries to walk on only Leg 1 (Temple Worship without Small Group Community), their spiritual walk is crippled! In a large congregation, you can hide in a crowd; but in a small group, you are known, loved, held accountable, and cared for.

As a volunteer jail chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jail, I have seen this principle proven behind steel bars. In a correctional facility, an inmate who tries to survive as a solo Christian is quickly targeted by gangs or overwhelmed by depression. But when inmates form **daily Bible study pods** in their cells—locking arms, studying KJV Scripture, praying for each other’s legal cases, and holding each other accountable—they become an unshakeable phalanx of faith!

The New Testament “One Anothers”

In the King James New Testament, the Holy Spirit gives over 50 explicit **“One Another”** commands that are physically impossible to obey unless you are plugged into a small group community:

You cannot “bear one another’s burdens” with a stranger sitting three rows ahead of you in a Sunday sermon. You only fulfill the “One Another” code when you sit in a circle, open your heart, and share life together!

Iron Sharpening Iron: The Power of Accountability

“Iron sharpeneth iron; so a man sharpeneth the countenance of his friend.” — Proverbs 27:17 (KJV)

When two iron blades rub against each other, friction creates sparks—and that friction grinds away dull edges until both blades become razor-sharp!

A true small group is not just a polite tea party; it is an **iron-sharpening workshop**! You need godly brothers and sisters who love you enough to:

- ✦ Ask you how your daily Bible reading and prayer life are going.
- ✦ Challenge you when you are drifting into worldly attitudes or compromise.
- ✦ Encourage you when you feel like quitting under intense stress.

“Let’s Get Real”: Overcoming Past Church Hurt & Social Shyness

Two common barriers stop growing believers from joining a small group:

1. **“I am shy and don’t like opening up to strangers.”** Remember that everyone in the room felt nervous on their first night! Focus on being a blessing to others rather than worrying about your performance. Listening with empathy is the greatest gift you can bring.
2. **“I was hurt by Christians in a past group or church.”**

Don’t let a Judas ruin your relationship with the eleven faithful Apostles! Offense is Satan’s trap to isolate you. Forgive the past, guard your heart with grace, and ask God to lead you to a healthy, loving small group.

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **The Lone Ember:** Read Ecclesiastes 4:9-10. Have you ever experienced a season where isolating yourself caused your spiritual fire to cool down?
2. **Two-Legged Church:** Are you currently walking on both legs of church life (Temple Worship AND Small Group Community), or are you hobbling on one leg?
3. **Iron Sharpening Iron:** Look at Proverbs 27:17. Who is currently the “iron” sharpening your spiritual life with love and accountability?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

- ✦ **Practical Action Step:** Contact your church leadership or visit the information desk this Sunday and sign up for a **Small Group / Home Bible Study**. Commit to attending for six consecutive weeks to build deep spiritual relationships!
- ✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

“Heavenly Father, God of Family and Community, thank You that You set the solitary in families! Forgive me for isolation, pride, or fear that kept me from deep fellowship. Today I pledge to plug into a small group family. Give me godly friends who will sharpen my faith, bear my burdens, and hold me accountable to walk in holiness. Keep my soul burning hot like a ember in the center of Your fire. In Jesus’ glorious Name, Amen.”

CHAPTER 6: UNDERSTANDING YOUR S.H.A.P.E.: GOD'S CUSTOM MASTERPIECE

“For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them.” — Ephesians 2:10 (KJV)

Assembly-Line Trinkets vs. The Master Artisan's Custom Poem

Imagine walking into a dollar store and buying a mass-produced plastic toy. Thousands of them roll off a factory assembly line in China every hour—identical, cheap, flimsy, and disposable. If one breaks, you toss it in the trash without a second thought.

Now, imagine walking into the studio of a world-famous master sculptor. He spends six months hand-carving a single block of rare marble. Every curve, every line, and every detail is sculpted with painstaking precision and passion. When it is finished, it is an priceless, irreplaceable masterpiece!

Tragically, millions of believers view themselves like cheap dollar-store trinkets! They look in the mirror and compare themselves to famous preachers, singers, or wealthy leaders, murmuring: *“I don't have talent. I am just a nobody sitting in a pew. God can't use someone like me.”*

Stop believing Satan's lies!

In Ephesians 2:10, the Holy Spirit declares an unshakeable truth about your divine identity: **“For we are his workmanship...”**

The Greek word Paul uses for *workmanship* is **poiema** (from which we derive our English word *poem*!). You are not a mass-produced, assembly-line accident. **You are God's custom-designed masterpiece, His handcrafted epic poem!**

“I will praise thee; for I am fearfully and wonderfully made: marvellous are thy works; and that my soul knoweth right well.” — Psalm 139:14 (KJV)

Pre-Ordained Blueprints: A KJV Exegesis of Ephesians 2:10

Notice the second half of Ephesians 2:10: “*created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them.*”

The Greek word for *before ordained* is **proetoimazo**. It means that before you were ever born, God prepared a custom-fitted set of Kingdom assignments, good works, and ministry doors specifically designed for *your* exact identity!

God never creates a person without a purpose, and He never assigns a purpose without equipping you with the exact tools to fulfill it.

As a volunteer jail chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jail, I have sat across the table from incarcerated men who were crushed by shame. Society gave them an inmate number, a criminal record, and labeled them as “felons” discarded on the trash heap of life.

But when we open KJV Scripture and walk through the **S.H.A.P.E.** framework, tears stream down their faces! They realize that God didn’t throw them away. God is redeeming their past scars, their hard street experiences, and their natural leadership traits to make them powerful chaplains and evangelists inside prison walls! If God can turn an inmate’s life into a royal Kingdom masterpiece, He will do the exact same with your life!

Unpacking the S.H.A.P.E. Framework

To help you discover your unique design and find your exact ministry fit, King Jesus has configured you through five distinct dimensions:

The Danger of Square Pegs in Round Holes

What happens when a church forces a believer into a ministry position that completely opposes their S.H.A.P.E.?

- ✦ If you force a quiet, detail-oriented **Introvert** with administrative gifts to stand on a street corner shouting through a bullhorn, they will suffer severe anxiety, feel useless, and burn out in two weeks.
- ✦ If you force a passionate, high-energy **Evangelist** to sit in a quiet back room filing financial receipts all day, they will feel trapped and frustrated!

When you serve *outside* your S.H.A.P.E., ministry feels like dragging a heavy sled across dry gravel. But when you discover your S.H.A.P.E. and plug into your custom ministry fit, **serving God feels like an eagle soaring on a high wind!**

“Let’s Get Real”: Stop Comparing Your Poem to Others!

1 Corinthians 12:15-18 exposes the foolishness of spiritual comparison: “*If the foot shall say, Because I am not the hand, I am not of the body; is it therefore not of the body?*”

An eye cannot smell, a hand cannot walk, and an ear cannot see. But the body needs every single organ to function in divine health! Stop wishing you had another leader’s voice, personality, or gifts. Embrace the unique, beautiful *poiema* God created you to be!

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **God's Poem:** Read Ephesians 2:10. How does knowing you are God's custom *poiema* (masterpiece) change how you view your self-worth and purpose?
2. **Pre-Ordained Assignment:** Look at the word *proetoimazo* (before ordained). What special causes, people groups, or ministry needs has God put on your heart?
3. **The Comparison Trap:** Read 1 Corinthians 12:15-18. Have you ever fallen into the trap of comparing your gifts to someone else? How can you break free from that today?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

✦ **Practical Action Step:** Get ready for the next five chapters! Prepare a dedicated notepad or print out your **S.H.A.P.E. Worksheets**. As we examine each letter (S - H - A - P - E), fill out your profile step-by-step!

✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

"Father in Heaven, Master Sculptor of my soul, thank You for creating me as Your unique masterpiece! Forgive me for comparing myself to others or belittling the design You gave me. Today I surrender my Spiritual Gifts, my Heart, my Abilities, my Personality, and my Past Experiences to You. Open my eyes as I study this framework, and lead me into the exact good works You pre-ordained for my life. In Jesus' glorious Name, Amen."

CHAPTER 7: S — SPIRITUAL GIFTS: YOUR SUPERNATURAL KINGDOM TOOLBOX

“As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another, as good stewards of the manifold grace of God.” — 1 Peter 4:10 (KJV)

Natural Talents vs. Supernatural Spiritual Gifts

Imagine a master carpenter stepping onto a construction site with a bag of cheap plastic toy tools. He has a plastic hammer that squeaks when it hits a nail, a plastic saw that cannot cut paper, and a plastic tape measure that snaps. No matter how much he sweats, he cannot build a house with toy tools!

Yet, millions of Christians attempt to build the Kingdom of God using only their human natural talents!

There is a vast, eternal difference between **Natural Talents** and **Supernatural Spiritual Gifts**:

- ✦ **Natural Talents** (e.g., athletic ability, musical pitch, public speaking, accounting) are inherited at physical birth. Unbelievers have natural talents!
- ✦ **Supernatural Spiritual Gifts** (Greek: **Charisma**) are imparted by the Holy Spirit at your spiritual rebirth (salvation). They are divine empowerments designed to break demonic strongholds, build up the church, and win lost souls!

In 1 Peter 4:10, Scripture declares: *“As every man hath received the gift...”*

Read those words carefully! If you are a born-again believer, **you have received at least one supernatural Spiritual Gift!** You are not giftless, you are not powerless, and you are not an observer. In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, God has handed you a custom **Supernatural Kingdom Toolbox!**

Manifold Grace: A KJV Exegesis of 1 Peter 4:10 & 1 Cor 12:7

In 1 Peter 4:10, Peter uses a magnificent word to describe God’s grace: **“manifold grace”**.

The Greek word for *manifold* is **poikilos**, which literally means multi-colored, woven with intricate tapestry, or infinite in variety! Just as a master weaver combines gold, crimson, blue, and purple threads

into a radiant royal robe, the Holy Spirit weaves different spiritual gifts into the Church so that the full glory of Christ is displayed.

Furthermore, 1 Corinthians 12:7 reveals the divine purpose of your gift:

“But the manifestation of the Spirit is given to every man to profit withal.” — 1 Corinthians 12:7 (KJV)

The phrase *to profit withal* (*pros to sympheron*) means **for the common good of the entire body!**

Your spiritual gift was never given for your personal ego, financial profit, or self-exaltation. Your gift was given as a sacred trust to build up your brothers and sisters, strengthen your local church, and pull lost souls out of darkness!

As Vice President of Gideons International in North Seminole County, Florida, and as a volunteer chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jails, I see the *manifold grace* of spiritual gifts in action every day. When we enter a jail pod or host a Scripture distribution, one team member operates in the gift of **Administration** (organizing logistics), another in **Exhortation** (boldly preaching the Word), another in **Mercy** (humbly listening to a weeping prisoner), and another in **Encouragement** (praying over broken hearts). When all the gifts operate in harmony, the Holy Spirit moves with unstoppable power!

The 9 Core Ministry Spiritual Gifts Defined

While the New Testament lists over 20 manifestations of the Spirit (Romans 12, 1 Corinthians 12, Ephesians 4, 1 Peter 4), here are the **9 Core Ministry Gifts** that build the local church:

Interactive Spiritual Gifts Self-Assessment Checklist

Read through the 9 statements below. Rate each statement on a scale of **1 to 5** (1 = Never true of me, 5 = Consistently true of my heart):

Scoring Key: Your highest scores (4s and 5s) point directly toward your primary Spiritual Gifts!

“Let’s Get Real”: The 3-Test Confirmation Formula

How do you confirm if a spiritual gift is truly operating in your life? Use the **3-Test Formula**:

1. **Internal Joy Test:** Do you experience supernatural delight and fulfillment when operating in this gift?
2. **External Fruit Test:** Do others actually get blessed, healed, saved, or equipped when you use this gift?
3. **Corporate Confirmation Test:** Do mature pastors, elders, and spiritual brothers/sisters confirm and recognize this gift in you?

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **Manifold Grace:** Read 1 Peter 4:10. How does knowing that your gift is part of God’s “manifold grace” stop you from comparing your gift to others?
2. **Your Primary Gift:** Looking at your self-assessment scores above, which two spiritual gifts scored highest for you?
3. **The Common Good:** Read 1 Corinthians 12:7. How can you deploy your primary spiritual gift in your local church over the next 30 days to profit the body of Christ?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

✦ **Practical Action Step:** Record your top 3 highest-scoring Spiritual Gifts into your **S.H.A.P.E. Summary Profile** in Chapter 11. Schedule a 15-minute chat with your small group leader or pastor to share your gift discovery!

✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

“Lord God Almighty, Giver of every good and perfect gift, thank You for imparting supernatural Spiritual Gifts into my life at salvation! Forgive me for ignoring or burying my tools out of fear. Open my eyes to recognize my primary gifts, and give me holy boldness to deploy them as a faithful steward of Your manifold grace. Use my gifts as a prophet, priest, and king to build Your church and win eternal souls. In Jesus’ glorious Name, Amen.”

CHAPTER 8: H — HEART & PASSIONS: UNLOCKING YOUR GOD-GIVEN MOTIVATION

“Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life.” — Proverbs 4:23 (KJV)

What Fires You Up and What Breaks Your Heart?

Have you ever watched two people walk into the exact same room and notice two completely different things?

- ✦ The first person walks in, notices the flickering overhead lightbulbs, the squeaky door hinges, and the unorganized chairs. They immediately feel an irresistible urge to grab a toolbox, fix the door, and arrange the room in perfect order!
- ✦ The second person walks into that exact same room, completely ignores the lightbulbs and door hinges, but immediately notices a lonely teenager sitting in a corner with tears in her eyes. They feel a deep, aching urge in their chest to sit down next to her, put an arm around her shoulder, and listen to her pain!

Why did these two people react so differently?

Because God gave them two completely different **HEARTS**!

In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, the second letter of your S.H.A.P.E. is **H — HEART & PASSIONS**. Your Heart is the internal emotional compass, the divine engine of passion that drives what you care about, what you dream about, and where you invest your emotional energy!

“Delight thyself also in the LORD; and he shall give thee the desires of thine heart.” — Psalm 37:4 (KJV)

When you delight in the Lord, God does not just grant your selfish wishes; **He implants HIS divine burdens, desires, and passions directly inside your heart!**

The Springs of Life: A KJV Exegesis of Proverbs 4:23

In Proverbs 4:23, King Solomon gives a royal directive: *“Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life.”*

The Hebrew word for *issues* is **totza’ot**, which literally means the outflowing streams, boundaries, or water springs of a city! In ancient times, if an enemy poisoned the water spring outside a city, the entire population died.

Your heart is the emotional water spring of your soul! Whatever fills your heart will inevitably dictate your words, your priorities, your money, and your ministry direction (Matthew 12:34).

Look at the Prophet Nehemiah in the Old Testament. When Nehemiah heard that the walls of Jerusalem were broken down and the gates burned with fire, he didn’t just shrug his shoulders. Scripture says: *“I sat down and wept, and mourned certain days, and fasted, and prayed before the God of heaven”* (Nehemiah 1:4).

Nehemiah’s **Holy Burden** broke his heart—and that broken heart motivated him to leave his comfortable job as cupbearer to the King of Persia, travel to Jerusalem, and rebuild the walls in 52 days!

As a volunteer jail chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jail, and Vice President of Gideons International in North Seminole County, Florida, God birthed a specific **Heart Burden** inside my soul 47 years ago. My heart breaks for men trapped behind iron bars and for souls wandering without God’s Word. When you find the specific cause that makes your heart weep, **you have discovered your God-given Heart Passion!**

The 3 Heart Discovery Questions

To uncover the specific Heart Passions God built into your design, answer these **3 Core Questions**:

The Heart & Passion People-Group Matrix

Examine the table below to see how different Heart Passions align with specific ministry fields in the local church and community:

| **Target People Group** | **Core Heart Burden** | **Primary Ministry Alignment** |

| :----- | | :----- | | :
----- |

| **Incarcerated / Ex-Offenders** | Breaking crime cycles & ministering behind bars | Jail & Prison Chaplaincy (gnglobal.org) |

| **Children & Toddlers** | Building early foundations in God’s Word | Kids Ministry, Nursery, VBS |

| **Youth & Teenagers** | Guiding teens through cultural pressures | Student Ministry, Youth Discipleship |

| **The Poor & Homeless** | Meeting physical hunger & shelter needs | Food Pantry, Homeless Shelter Outreach |

| **Seniors & Shut-Ins** | Bringing comfort to lonely & elderly souls | Nursing Home Ministry, Home Visitation |

| **International Students / Immigrants** | Welcoming strangers & cross-cultural friendship | International Student Hospitality, ESL |

| **Unreached Nations / Bible Distribution** | Placing God's Word into every hand globally | Gideons International (gideons.org), Global Missions |

“Let’s Get Real”: Distinguishing Selfish Desires from Holy Passion

How do you distinguish between a Holy Passion from God and a selfish human desire?

- ✦ **Selfish Human Desire:** Driven by pride, ambition, and the pursuit of applause. It asks: *“What will make ME look impressive, famous, or powerful?”*
- ✦ **Holy Spirit Passion:** Driven by love, humility, and the glory of King Jesus. It asks: *“What will heal hurting souls, advance the Gospel, and bring glory to GOD?”*

When a passion is from God, it remains steady through trials, financial strain, and hardship!

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **Nehemiah’s Burden:** Read Nehemiah 1:4. What specific spiritual or human suffering causes you to weep or feel a deep holy burden?
2. **Target People Group:** Look at the Heart & Passion Matrix above. Which specific people group (children, youth, prisoners, seniors, poor, international) do you feel most drawn to serve?
3. **Proverbs 4:23:** What steps must you take to guard your heart (*totza’ot*) against worldly distractions so your Holy Passion stays burning bright?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

- ✦ **Practical Action Step:** Write down your top **Heart Burden** and primary **Target People Group** into your **S.H.A.P.E. Summary Profile** in Chapter 11.
- ✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

“Lord God of Nehemiah, thank You for giving me a heart that feels Your divine compassion! Forgive me for seasons of apathy where I cared more about worldly entertainment than hurting souls. Impart Your holy burden into my heart today. Tell me what breaks Your heart, and use my life as a prophet, priest, and king to rebuild broken walls and bring healing to the people group You called me to serve. In Jesus’ victorious Name, Amen.”

CHAPTER 9: A & P — ABILITIES & PERSONALITY: HARNESSING TALENTS & TEMPERAMENT

“And I have filled him with the spirit of God, in wisdom, and in understanding, and in knowledge, and in all manner of workmanship, To devise cunning works, to work in gold, and in silver, and in brass...” — Exodus 31:3-4 (KJV)

The Holy Spirit Anoints Artisans and Technicians

If you ask the average churchgoer to name someone filled with the Holy Spirit in the Bible, they will usually name Moses splitting the Red Sea, Elijah calling down fire from Heaven, or Peter preaching at Pentecost.

Hardly anyone ever names **Bezalel**!

Yet, in Exodus 31:1-5, Bezalel is the **very first person in the Bible explicitly described as being filled with the Spirit of God!** And what was Bezalel’s spiritual assignment? Was he an eloquent preacher or a miracle-working prophet?

No! Bezalel was a **master craftsman, artist, and metalworker!** God filled him with the Holy Spirit to carve wood, refine gold and silver, cut precious stones, and construct the physical Tabernacle!

Tragically, modern Christianity has erected a false, unbiblical wall between “sacred” gifts (preaching and singing) and “secular” abilities (carpentry, graphic design, IT, accounting, cooking, and management).

Stop believing that lie! In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, **every natural ability, vocational skill, and unique personality trait God gave you was designed to advance His Kingdom!**

Part 1: [A] — ABILITIES (Your Vocational Toolbelt)

Abilities are the natural talents and vocational skills you learned through school, career, hobbies, and life experience. When submitted to King Jesus, these abilities become mighty Kingdom weapons!

Examine the **5 Core Skill Clusters** below to identify your primary vocational abilities:

Through my work as Vice President of Gideons International in North Seminole County, Florida, and as a volunteer chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jails, I see how crucial these abilities are. When we organize a prison chapel service or launch a global Scripture distribution, we need team members with **Administrative abilities** to coordinate clearance passes, **Technical abilities** to manage sound systems, and **Practical abilities** to handle logistics. Without Bezalel’s abilities, Moses’ preaching cannot reach the crowd!

Part 2: [P] — PERSONALITY (Your Divine Temperament)

God never uses a Cookie-Cutter machine to stamp out Christians! In His infinite wisdom, the Lord engineered a wide spectrum of human temperaments.

Your **Personality** is your natural behavioral style—how you process information, recharge your energy, and interact with people.

To discover your unique Personality profile, examine the **2-Axis Behavioral Matrix**:

1. Profile 1: Extrovert + People-Focused (The Warm Champion)

- ✦ *Traits*: Outgoing, high-energy, loves crowds, highly expressive, warm communicator.
- ✦ *Best Ministry Fit*: Door Greeters, Host Teams, Youth Leaders, Small Group Leaders.

2. Profile 2: Extrovert + Task-Focused (The Driving Pioneer)

- ✦ *Traits*: Goal-oriented, decisive, confident, loves initiating new projects, direct speaker.
- ✦ *Best Ministry Fit*: Event Chairs, Outreach Directors, Ministry Team Captains.

3. Profile 3: Introvert + Task-Focused (The Detail Guardian)

- ✦ *Traits*: Quiet, analytical, structured, highly organized, prefers working behind the scenes.
- ✦ *Best Ministry Fit*: Financial Trustees, IT / Database Ops, Tech Team, Facility Care.

4. Profile 4: Introvert + People-Focused (The Quiet Counselor)

- ✦ *Traits*: Gentle, empathetic listener, prefers 1-on-1 conversations, deep thinker.
- ✦ *Best Ministry Fit*: Prayer Intercessors, One-on-One Mentors, Hospital & Prison Care.

“Let’s Get Real”: Honoring Your Personality Without Excusing Sin

Understanding your personality gives you self-awareness, but **it never gives you a license to sin or compromise**:

- ✦ **Introverts** cannot say: “*I’m an introvert, so I don’t have to welcome strangers or love my neighbor.*” (The Bible commands all Christians to show love and hospitality!).

- ✦ **Extroverts** cannot say: *“I’m an extrovert, so I’m allowed to dominate conversations and gossip.”* (The Bible commands all Christians to guard their tongue!).

Use your personality as a custom vessel to serve God, while letting the Holy Spirit mature your character!

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **Bezalel’s Anointing:** Read Exodus 31:1-5. How does knowing that Bezalel was filled with the Holy Spirit to do carpentry and metalwork change how you view your everyday job skills?
2. **Abilities Inventory:** Which of the 5 Kingdom Skill Clusters (Technical, Administrative, Craftsmanship, Artistic, Relational) best describes your natural abilities?
3. **Personality Matrix:** Looking at the 4 Personality Profiles above, which quadrant (Warm Champion, Driving Pioneer, Detail Guardian, Quiet Counselor) describes your temperament?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

- ✦ **Practical Action Step:** Record your primary **Abilities** and your **Personality Profile** into your **S.H.A.P.E. Summary Profile** in Chapter 11.
- ✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

“Lord God of Bezalel, thank You for filling me with natural abilities, practical skills, and a unique personality! Forgive me for considering my everyday skills as ‘secular’ or useless in Your house. Today I place my toolbelt, my mind, and my temperament upon Your altar. Anoint my abilities by Your Holy Spirit, and use my unique design as a prophet, priest, and king to build up Your house and advance Your Kingdom. In Jesus’ mighty Name, Amen.”

CHAPTER 10: E — LEVERAGING YOUR EXPERIENCES: GOD NEVER WASTES A HURT

“Blessed be God, even the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies, and the God of all comfort; Who comforteth us in all our tribulation, that we may be able to comfort them which are in any trouble, by the comfort wherewith we ourselves are comforted of God.” — 2 Corinthians 1:3-4 (KJV)

From Trash Heap to Trophy of Grace

Imagine walking through an antique shop and seeing an old, rusted iron sword from the 18th century. It is covered in dirt, pitted with rust, and has a nicked blade from ancient battles. Most people would glance at it and call it junk.

Now imagine a master blacksmith buying that rusted sword. He places it into a roaring furnace, heats the metal until it glows bright orange, hammers away the imperfections, polishes the blade until it shines like a mirror, and fits it with a new gold-hilted grip. That once-discarded weapon is now the centerpiece of the museum!

In the spiritual realm, Satan loves to whisper to growing believers: *“Look at your past! Look at your divorce, your bankruptcy, your addiction, your criminal record, or your painful failures. You are damaged goods! God can never use someone with a past like yours.”*

Silence the Accuser with the unshakeable Word of God!

In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, the final letter of your S.H.A.P.E. is **E — EXPERIENCES**.

God does not manufacture His greatest leaders in ivory towers free from pain. **God raises His greatest leaders out of the furnace of trial!**

“And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to his purpose.” — Romans 8:28 (KJV)

Notice that Scripture does not say all experiences *are* good. Sickness, abuse, betrayal, and sin are evil! But God promises that when you surrender your past to Him, **He works ALL things together for good!**

The Comfort Reservoir: A KJV Exegesis of 2 Corinthians 1:3-4

In 2 Corinthians 1:3-4, the Apostle Paul reveals the profound spiritual mystery of human suffering: *“Who comforteth us in all our tribulation, that we may be able to comfort them which are in any trouble...”*

Look at the key words in this passage:

1. **“Tribulation” (Thlipsis):** Literally means crushing pressure, intense affliction, or being squeezed in a winepress.
2. **“Comfort” (Paraklesis):** Coming alongside someone to impart strength, hope, and courage.

Why did God allow you to walk through that crushing furnace of affliction?

God allowed you to receive His supernatural comfort so that your heart would become a **Reservoir of Comfort** for others! You cannot truly comfort a weeping soul with dry, academic theology. But when you have walked through the dark valley of grief, addiction, financial collapse, or heartbreak and experienced God’s miraculous comfort, you can look a hurting brother in the eye and say with unshakeable authority: *“I stood where you are standing. God carried me through, and He will carry you through!”*

As a volunteer jail chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jail, I witness this truth every single week. When a polished speaker who has never spent a night behind bars preaches to incarcerated men, the inmates often listen politely. But when an ex-offender who sat on that exact concrete floor, wore those exact orange scrubs, and was redeemed by the blood of Jesus stands up to speak, **the whole room goes silent!** His scars become his credentials. God never wastes a scar!

The 5 Streams of Life Experience

To audit how God has prepared your life for unique Kingdom impact, examine the **5 Streams of Experience**:

The Wounded Healer Principle: Joseph’s Revelation

Consider Joseph in the Book of Genesis. His brothers betrayed him, sold him into slavery, and he spent 13 years falsely accused in an Egyptian dungeon.

Yet, when Joseph was elevated to Prime Minister of Egypt and confronted his weeping brothers, he did not seek revenge. He declared:

“But as for you, ye thought evil against me; but God meant it unto good, to bring to pass, as it is this day, to save much people alive.” — Genesis 50:20 (KJV)

Your deepest ministry calling will often emerge out of your deepest personal pain!

- ✦ A person who survived bankruptcy is uniquely anointed to teach biblical stewardship.
- ✦ A person who recovered from addiction is uniquely anointed to lead recovery ministries.

- ✦ A person who walked through a painful divorce and experienced God's restoration is uniquely anointed to comfort broken single parents.

“Let’s Get Real”: Healed Scars vs. Open Wounds

Before you leverage a painful experience to minister to others, make sure your hurt is a **healed scar** and not an **open wound**:

- ✦ An **Open Wound** is still bleeding, bitter, and angry. If you try to minister out of an open wound, you will bleed on the people you are trying to help.
- ✦ A **Healed Scar** is a closed wound covered by the grace of God. It no longer hurts to touch, and it stands as a permanent trophy of resurrection power!

Allow the High Priest, Jesus Christ, to fully heal your wounds before you step onto the battlefield to help others.

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **Genesis 50:20**: How does Joseph's declaration (“*Ye thought evil against me; but God meant it unto good*”) help you view your most painful past trials?
2. **2 Corinthians 1:3-4**: What specific trial or grief have you walked through where you experienced God's supernatural comfort? Who can you comfort with that same story today?
3. **Scars vs. Wounds**: Are there any past hurts in your life that are still “open wounds” requiring prayer and pastoral counseling before you can leverage them in ministry?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

- ✦ **Practical Action Step**: Complete your **5 Streams of Life Experience Audit** by writing down your top Painful, Spiritual, Vocational, Relational, and Ministry experiences into your **S.H.A.P.E. Summary Profile** in Chapter 11.

- ✦ **Commissioning Prayer**:

“Father of Mercies and God of All Comfort, thank You that You never waste a hurt! Forgive me for holding onto shame, bitterness, or regret over my past. Today I place all my painful trials, my vocational background, and my life experiences into Your hands. Turn my past scars into trophies of Your grace. Use my story as a prophet, priest, and king to bring hope, comfort, and salvation to broken souls. In the victorious Name of Jesus Christ, Amen.”

CHAPTER 11: YOUR S.H.A.P.E. SUMMARY PROFILE: SYNTHESIZING YOUR DESIGN

“I will praise thee; for I am fearfully and wonderfully made: marvellous are thy works; and that my soul knoweth right well.” — Psalm 139:14 (KJV)

Bringing the Five Pieces of Your Puzzle Together

Imagine opening a 1,000-piece jigsaw puzzle box. You spill the cardboard pieces out onto a table. For hours, you sort the pieces into piles—corner border pieces, blue sky pieces, green mountain pieces, and water pieces.

As long as those pieces remain separated in different piles, you cannot see the magnificent landscape picture! But the moment you snap the border pieces together and connect the sky to the mountains, the breathtaking masterpiece comes into full view.

Over the past five chapters, you have been sorting the five unique pieces of your spiritual puzzle:

- ✦ [S] — Your supernatural **Spiritual Gifts** (Chapter 7)
- ✦ [H] — Your God-given **Heart & Passions** (Chapter 8)
- ✦ [A] — Your vocational **Abilities** (Chapter 9)
- ✦ [P] — Your unique **Personality** (Chapter 9)
- ✦ [E] — Your redeemed **Experiences** (Chapter 10)

Now, it is time to snap all five pieces together! In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, Chapter 11 is your **Master S.H.A.P.E. Synthesis**—the chapter where your personal Kingdom Blueprint comes into crystal-clear focus!

Set Apart by Divine Design: A KJV Exegesis of Psalm 139:14

In Psalm 139:14, King David declares: *“I am fearfully and wonderfully made...”*

Look at the two Hebrew words David uses:

1. **“Fearfully” (Yareʿ):** Made with holy awe, reverence, and meticulous divine attention.

2. “Wonderfully” (*Pala*): Set apart, distinguished, uniquely crafted, and separated from ordinary things!

God did not scatter your gifts, heart, abilities, personality, and experiences by accident. Every detail of your background was woven together by the Holy Spirit to prepare you for a specific, pre-ordained ministry assignment (Ephesians 2:10).

As a volunteer jail chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jail, and Vice President of Gideons International in North Seminole County, Florida, one of my greatest moments in discipleship is watching a believer complete their **S.H.A.P.E. Summary Profile**.

I have watched an incarcerated man in a jail pod write down his profile:

- ✦ *Spiritual Gift*: **Exhortation & Teaching**
- ✦ *Heart Burden*: **Incarcerated men & youth in crime**
- ✦ *Abilities*: **Public speaking & athletics**
- ✦ *Personality*: **Extrovert / People-Focused (Warm Champion)**
- ✦ *Experience*: **Redeemed 10-year street past & prison transformation**

When he looks down at that completed sheet, tears fill his eyes. He realizes: “*I am not trash! God custom-fitted me to be an unstoppable chaplain and mentor inside this prison!*”

If God can synthesize an inmate’s life into a mighty Kingdom weapon, He will do the exact same with your S.H.A.P.E.!

The Official Master S.H.A.P.E. Profile Worksheet

Fill out every section of the **Master S.H.A.P.E. Profile Worksheet** below by pulling your top results from Chapters 7 through 10:

The Ministry Fit Formula

To translate your completed profile into a clear ministry direction, use the **Ministry Fit Formula**:

Case Study Example:

- ✦ **Sarah’s S.H.A.P.E.:**
- ✦ *Spiritual Gift*: **Hospitality & Mercy**
- ✦ *Heart Burden*: **Single Mothers & Young Families**
- ✦ *Abilities*: **Cooking, Event Coordination, Budgeting**
- ✦ *Personality*: **Quiet Counselor (Introvert + People-Focused)**
- ✦ *Experience*: **Walked through single parenting for 5 years**
- ✦ **Sarah’s Ideal Ministry Fit**: Leading a monthly home-based hospitality & care support group for single mothers in her local church!

“Let’s Get Real”: How to Present Your Profile to Church Leaders

Once your Master S.H.A.P.E. Profile is complete, do not hide it under a bushel (Matthew 5:15)!

Schedule a 15-minute coffee or meeting with your small group leader, pastor, or volunteer coordinator. Hand them a copy of your completed sheet and say: *“I have completed my S.H.A.P.E. discovery. I want to deploy my gifts, heart, abilities, personality, and experiences to serve our church family. Where can I plug in?”*

Pastors love believers who come ready with a clear S.H.A.P.E. profile!

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **Fearfully and Wonderfully Made:** Read Psalm 139:14. How does looking at your completed S.H.A.P.E. profile prove that God set you apart with divine intentionality?
2. **The Ministry Fit Formula:** Look at your completed worksheet above. What specific ministry role or team in your local church aligns best with your 5 dimensions?
3. **Presenting Your Profile:** What step will you take this week to share your S.H.A.P.E. profile with a leader or mentor in your church?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

- ✦ **Practical Action Step:** Complete every line of the **Master S.H.A.P.E. Profile Worksheet** above. Take a photo or make a copy of your sheet to present to your church leadership in Chapter 12!
- ✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

“Heavenly Father, Master Artisan of my soul, I praise You today because I am fearfully and wonderfully made! Thank You for snapping all five pieces of my S.H.A.P.E. puzzle together. I dedicate my Spiritual Gifts, my Heart, my Abilities, my Personality, and my Experiences to Your Kingdom. Use my unique blueprint as a prophet, priest, and king to serve Your house with joy and excellence. In Jesus’ victorious Name, Amen.”

CHAPTER 12: FINDING YOUR MINISTRY FIT: PLUGGING INTO THE BODY

“But now hath God set the members every one of them in the body, as it hath pleased him.” — 1 Corinthians 12:18 (KJV)

From Spectators in the Bleachers to Players on the Field

Imagine walking into a packed football stadium on a Saturday afternoon.

Down on the field, 22 players in uniform are running at full speed, tackling, passing, sweating, and pouring out every ounce of energy to win the game. Up in the stands, 50,000 spectators sit in comfortable plastic seats, eating popcorn, drinking soda, and shouting advice or criticism at the players down on the field!

Tragically, this is the exact operational picture of the traditional Western church!

Sociologists call it the **80/20 Rule**: in most churches, 20% of the members do 80% of the work, pay 80% of the budget, and carry 80% of the ministry load—while the other 80% sit in comfortable padded pews as passive spectators!

King Jesus never built His Church to be a theater for passive spectators!

In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, **you were saved to serve, equipped to execute, and set apart for action!** You are not a spectator sitting in the bleachers; you are a key player on the field, wearing the uniform of Christ!

Divine Positioning: A KJV Exegesis of 1 Corinthians 12:18

In 1 Corinthians 12:18, the Holy Spirit reveals the sovereignty of God in church membership: *“But now hath God set the members every one of them in the body, as it hath pleased him.”*

Look closely at the Greek word Paul uses for *set*: **tithemi**. It means to strategically position, arrange with divine military precision, and appoint to a specific office!

God did not place you in your local church by random chance. **He strategically positioned (*tithemi*) you in that specific local body because your S.H.A.P.E. is needed there!**

If a human body is missing a hand, an eye, or a foot, the entire body is handicapped. Likewise, when you refuse to plug your S.H.A.P.E. into an active ministry team, your local church family is handicapped without your contribution!

As Vice President of Gideons International in North Seminole County, Florida, and as a volunteer chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jails, I see how divine positioning works. In our Gideon chapter and prison ministry teams, when every member operates in their divine positioning—some distributing KJV Bibles, some handling logistics, some preaching, and some praying—the Gospel moves like a tidal wave!

The 5 Major Ministry Arenas (Matching Profiles to Teams)

To help you translate your Master S.H.A.P.E. Profile into a concrete ministry assignment, examine the **5 Major Ministry Arenas** below:

The 3 Rules for Healthy Volunteer Service

To ensure your volunteer service brings long-term joy instead of burnout, follow these **3 Rules for Service**:

1. **Rule 1: Start with a 60-Day Trial** Don't feel pressured to make a lifetime commitment on day one! Ask for a 60-day trial period in a ministry team. If it turns out to be a great fit, commit long-term. If not, transition gracefully to another team.
2. **Rule 2: Serve in ONE Primary Area First** Avoid the trap of signing up for five different committees! Focus your energy on one primary ministry team that matches your S.H.A.P.E. so you serve with depth and excellence.
3. **Rule 3: Keep Your Heart Fixed on King Jesus**

Never serve for human applause, pastoral praise, or self-elevation. Colossians 3:23 commands: *“And whatsoever ye do, do it heartily, as to the Lord, and not unto men.”*

“Let’s Get Real”: What If My First Placement Isn’t a Good Fit?

If you try a volunteer team for 60 days and realize it does not match your S.H.A.P.E., **do not quit church or feel guilty!**

Simply go to the team leader and say with grace: *“Thank you for allowing me to serve on this team. I have realized that my S.H.A.P.E. is better suited for the Care Team / Tech Team / Outreach Team, so I will be transitioning there next month.”*

Healthy leaders will celebrate your self-awareness and help you transition to your right spot!

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **Divine Positioning:** Read 1 Corinthians 12:18. What does it mean to you personally that God strategically positioned (*tithemi*) you in your local church?
2. **Ministry Arenas:** Look at the 5 Ministry Arenas above. Which arena (Host, Next-Gen, Production, Care, or Outreach) matches your completed S.H.A.P.E. profile best?
3. **The 60-Day Trial:** What step will you take this Sunday to sign up for a 60-day trial in your primary ministry arena?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

- ✦ **Practical Action Step:** Visit your church's volunteer center, info desk, or contact your pastor this week. Hand them your completed **Master S.H.A.P.E. Profile** from Chapter 11 and sign up for a **60-Day Ministry Trial!**
- ✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

“Lord God of Hosts, Commander of the Lord’s Army, thank You for calling me out of the bleachers and onto the field of Kingdom service! Forgive me for seasons of passivity or hesitation. Today I step into my divine positioning in the body of Christ. Anoint me with Your Holy Spirit to serve my local church family with joy, humility, and power as a prophet, priest, and king. In Jesus’ mighty Name, Amen.”

CHAPTER 13: THE ACCOUNTABILITY FACTOR: LOCKING SHIELDS IN SPIRITUAL WARFARE

“Iron sharpeneth iron; so a man sharpeneth the countenance of his friend.” — Proverbs 27:17 (KJV)

The Tactics of the Roaring Lion

In the African savanna, a lion hunting a herd of gazelles does not charge straight into the center of the herd. If he rushes the entire herd, fifty fast gazelles will scatter in every direction, and the lion will tire out and go hungry.

Instead, the lion crouches in the tall grass, watches quietly, and waits.

He looks for **one isolated gazelle**—a young calf that wandered away from its mother, an injured male limping behind, or a distracted gazelle straggling fifty yards away from the herd. The moment that gazelle is isolated, the lion pounces!

The Apostle Peter warns us that Satan uses this exact hunting strategy:

“Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour.” — 1 Peter 5:8 (KJV)

Satan rarely attacks a believer who is surrounded by a tight, disciplined circle of praying brothers or sisters. The devil waits until you isolate yourself, keep secrets, and stop meeting with your accountability group. The moment you are isolated, he pounces with temptation, lust, fear, or discouragement!

In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, **Accountability is your spiritual armor wall!**

The Roman Phalanx Shield Wall: A KJV Exegesis of Ephesians 6:16 & Eccl 4:12

To understand why God created accountability, look at the Roman army that dominated the ancient world.

Each Roman soldier carried a massive rectangular shield called a **scutum** (measuring four feet high and two feet wide, constructed of bonded wood, leather, and metal rims).

If a single Roman soldier stood alone in an open field, an enemy archer could easily shoot an arrow around his exposed sides or back. But when the Roman legion formed up on the battlefield, the soldiers stood shoulder-to-shoulder, overlapped their curved shields, and locked them together into a continuous wall of iron and oak called the **Phalanx**!

When enemy archers fired thousands of flaming arrows into the sky, the Roman commander shouted, “**LOCK SHIELDS!**” The arrows slammed into the Phalanx wall and bounced off harmlessly into the dirt.

Paul had this exact military image in mind when he wrote Ephesians 6:16: “*Above all, taking the shield of faith, wherewith ye shall be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked.*”

When you lock your Shield of Faith with an accountability partner, **Satan’s fiery darts cannot penetrate your life!**

“And if one prevail against him, two shall withstand him; and a threefold cord is not quickly broken.” — Ecclesiastes 4:12 (KJV)

As a volunteer jail chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jail, I have seen this military principle proven behind steel bars. In a correctional facility, an inmate who tries to stand as a solo Christian is constantly harassed by gangs, pressure, and contraband. But when two or three Christian inmates form a **Phalanx Cell Pod**—praying every morning, checking on each other’s eyes and speech, and holding each other accountable—they become an unshakeable fortress of righteousness!

Confession for Healing: A KJV Exegesis of James 5:16

Notice the profound distinction King Jesus makes between forgiveness and healing:

“Confess your faults one to another, and pray one for another, that ye may be healed.” — James 5:16 (KJV)

Read that verse with deep spiritual discernment!

- ✦ You confess your sins to **God** for **Forgiveness** (1 John 1:9).
- ✦ You confess your faults to **One Another** for **Healing** (James 5:16)!

Secret sin thrives in darkness and shame. The moment you bring a secret struggle (pornography, anger, greed, fear, or addiction) into the light with a trusted, godly accountability partner, **Satan’s secret power over your soul is instantly broken!**

The 4 Master Questions for Weekly Accountability

Meet with your accountability partner weekly (in person or over the phone) and ask these **4 Master Questions** with 100% honesty:

“Let’s Get Real”: How to Choose a Godly Accountability Partner

Not everyone qualifies to be your accountability partner! Choose someone who meets these **3 Essential Criteria**:

1. **Same Gender**: Men with men, women with women. Never build deep emotional accountability across gender lines, as this can lead to emotional entanglements.
2. **Spiritual Maturity**: Choose someone who loves KJV Scripture, fears God, lives a holy life, and is not afraid to speak the truth in love (Proverbs 27:6).
3. **Absolute Confidentiality**: Your partner must be a vault! If someone gossips about others to you, they will gossip about you to others. Ensure 100% sacred trust.

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **The Isolated Gazelle**: Read 1 Peter 5:8. Have you ever experienced a season where isolating yourself allowed the devil to attack you with temptation or doubt?
2. **The Phalanx Wall**: Look at Ecclesiastes 4:12 and Ephesians 6:16. Who is the godly brother or sister in your life right now with whom you can lock shields?
3. **James 5:16**: Why does secret sin lose its grip the moment it is brought into the light with a trusted accountability partner?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

- ✦ **Practical Action Step**: Identify a godly Christian brother or sister today. Ask them to meet for 30 minutes this week to become your **Accountability Growth Partner**. Commit to asking each other the **4 Master Questions** weekly!
- ✦ **Commissioning Prayer**:

“Lord God of Angel Armies, thank You for giving me the Shield of Faith and surrounding me with the Body of Christ! Forgive me for pride, secrecy, or fear that kept me from walking in accountability. Today I choose to bring every dark corner of my life into Your Holy light. Give me a loyal, godly partner to lock shields with. As iron sharpens iron, sharpen my character, guard my purity, and make us an unshakeable phalanx for Your Kingdom as a prophet, priest, and king. In Jesus’ victorious Name, Amen.”

CHAPTER 14: YOUR NEXT STEP: COMMENCEMENT & READY TO GO!

“But grow in grace, and in the knowledge of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. To him be glory both now and for ever. Amen.” — 2 Peter 3:18 (KJV)

From Spiritual Childhood to Kingdom Commissioning

Congratulations, my beloved brother or sister in Christ!

You have reached a magnificent spiritual milestone on your journey. When you began this book, you set out to discover how to move beyond the foundational milk of salvation and step into the solid meat of spiritual maturity.

Look at what you have accomplished through the power of the Holy Spirit:

- ✦ You mastered the **4 Core Spiritual Habits**: The Habit of the Word (Chapter 2), The Habit of Prayer (Chapter 3), The Habit of Giving (Chapter 4), and The Habit of Community (Chapter 5).
- ✦ You uncovered the **5 Dimensions of your S.H.A.P.E.**: Your Spiritual Gifts (Chapter 7), Your Heart & Passions (Chapter 8), Your Abilities (Chapter 9), Your Personality (Chapter 9), and Your Redeemed Experiences (Chapter 10).
- ✦ You synthesized your **Master S.H.A.P.E. Profile** (Chapter 11), discovered your **Ministry Fit** (Chapter 12), and locked shields in **Accountability** (Chapter 13).

In your royal identity as a prophet, priest, and king, **this chapter is not a graduation into retirement; it is a Commencement into Action!**

Continuous Growth: A KJV Exegesis of 2 Peter 3:18 & 2 Timothy 2:2

In 2 Peter 3:18, the Apostle Peter gives his final written command to the Church: *“But grow in grace, and in the knowledge of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.”*

The Greek word for *grow* is **auxano**. It is in the present active imperative tense, which means **continuously expand, blossom, increase, and never stop growing!**

In the Kingdom of God, there is no plateau. You are either growing forward or drifting backward.

Furthermore, 2 Timothy 2:2 reveals the ultimate goal of all Christian discipleship:

“And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.” — 2 Timothy 2:2 (KJV)

Notice the **4-Generation Discipleship Chain** in this verse:

1. **Generation 1:** Paul (The Apostle)
2. **Generation 2:** Timothy (The Disciple)
3. **Generation 3:** Faithful Men (The Next Leaders)
4. **Generation 4:** Others Also (The Reached World!)

You were not saved and equipped just to enjoy your spiritual gifts in isolation. You were equipped so that you can turn around and disciple someone else!

As a volunteer jail chaplain in Seminole County and Orange County Jail, and Vice President of Gideons International in North Seminole County, Florida, the greatest joy of my 47-year walk with Jesus is watching a growing believer step out of the classroom, pick up the torch of faith, and start discipling others. When an inmate who was disciplined in a jail cell turns around and begins discipling new prisoners in his pod, **the 2 Timothy 2:2 chain is unleashed!**

The 3-Book Discipleship Journey Roadmap

You are now two-thirds of the way through **The Discipleship Journey Series**:

Official Book 2 Graduation Certificate Box

“Let’s Get Real”: Who Will You Disciple Next?

Now that you have completed Book 2, ask yourself this life-changing question: *“Who is the Timothy in my life?”*

Is there a new believer in your church, a young co-worker, a family member, or a friend who needs someone to walk alongside them?

Take a copy of **Book 1 (BELONG)**, sit down with them over coffee once a week, and start discipling them! The best way to solidify your own spiritual growth is to teach someone else.

Reflection & Deepening Questions

1. **Continuous Growth:** Read 2 Peter 3:18 (*auxano*). What specific spiritual habit will you maintain daily to ensure your growth never stagnates?
2. **The Discipleship Chain:** Look at 2 Timothy 2:2. Who is one person God is placing on your heart to mentor or disciple this year?
3. **Ready to GO:** How does discovering your S.H.A.P.E. make you feel prepared to step into **Book 3 (GO: Sharing Your Faith)**?

Action Step & Commissioning Prayer

- ✦ **Practical Action Step:** Turn immediately to **Book 3 (GO: Sharing Your Faith & Changing the World)**! Share your Book 2 completion certificate with your small group leader or pastor, and invite a friend to start Book 1 with you!
- ✦ **Commissioning Prayer:**

“Lord God Almighty, King of Kings and Lord of Lords, I give You all the glory, honor, and praise for carrying me through Book 2 of this Discipleship Journey! Thank You for anchoring my habits in Your Word, revealing my S.H.A.P.E., and positioning me in Your body. Today I declare that I am ready to GO! Anoint my mouth to share the Gospel, use my gifts to heal broken hearts, and make me a faithful spiritual parent who reproduces disciples for Your glory as a prophet, priest, and king. In the matchless Name of Jesus Christ, Amen.”



APPENDIX: ABOUT THE AUTHOR & MINISTRY VISION



ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Thomas Perdana (is a 59-year-old third-generation Chinese-Indonesian believer who surrendered his life to Jesus Christ at age 12. Walking with the Lord for over 47 years, his heart’s passion is to disciple believers, equip Kingdom leaders, and anchor new Christians in the unshakeable truth of God’s Word.

Thomas serves actively as a volunteer jail chaplain with **Good News Global** at the Seminole County Correctional Facility (and with **Orange County Jail Ministry** in Florida (bringing the transformational hope of the Gospel behind correctional bars. He also serves as Vice President of **The Gideons International** (North Seminole County Chapter, Florida) (dedicating his life to placing God’s Holy Word into hands across the globe.

Thomas and his family are active covenant members of **Westview Baptist Church** (in Sanford, Florida. Thank you for reading *The Discipleship Journey*! We invite you to partner with our discipleship ministry to help provide free books, study guides, and courses for seeking souls, prison chaplains, and overseas churches.



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